



ACTION REQUIRED: FY26 Employee Self-Assessment Tool Now Open!

From CISA Leadership <CISALeadershipFeds@cisa.dhs.gov>

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Employee Quick Guide - Self-Assessment.pdf;



Team CISA,

The Performance Calibration and Alignment System (PCAS) Employee Self-Assessment tool is now open - you can log in and complete your self-assessment at the following link:

<https://identity-portal.dhs.gov/pcas> **Deadline: September 30, 2026, at 11:59 PM EST**

Your self-assessment is your opportunity to highlight your accomplishments, contributions, challenges, and the impact your performance has had. A strong self-assessment explains *what* you accomplished, *how* you accomplished it, and *why* it mattered to our organization, customers, and mission.

Required Self-Assessment Sections

When drafting your self-assessment, you will need to provide input for the following key areas:

- **Individual Performance (Critical Elements):** Describe your performance and how it relates to the core competencies and, if applicable, your performance goals. Include specific and quantifiable accomplishments when able, including metrics, timelines, outcomes, and examples that show the impact of your work.
- **Mission Impact:** Describe the **mission impact** of your work and/or accomplishments, including how they advance the mission and operational capabilities of your work unit, Component, and/or the Department.
- **Organizational Effectiveness:** Describe how your work and/or accomplishments improved **organizational effectiveness**, including operations, processes, collaboration, resource use, service delivery, or overall performance within your work unit, Component, and/or the Department.
- **Administration Priorities:** Describe how your work and/or accomplishments helped advance the **Administration's priorities**. For example, work you completed relating to an Executive Order, Presidential Management Agenda, or another Government-wide Directive.

You will have the opportunity to upload up to two supporting documents in each section.

Examples of Strong Self-Assessment Statements

Mission Impact

- **Border Patrol Agent:** "Demonstrated exceptional vigilance during patrol operations in the [Sector Name], resulting in the interdiction of [Number] pounds of illicit narcotics. This directly supported the

agency's core mission to secure the border and prevent transnational threats from entering the country."

- **Transportation Security Officer (TSO):** "Successfully screened over [Number] passengers during the peak holiday travel season while maintaining a 100% compliance rate with standard operating procedures. This ensured the safety of the traveling public and supported the agency's mission to protect the nation's transportation systems."
- **IT Specialist:** "Designed and deployed a new secure data-sharing portal that reduced system latency by 20% across all field offices. This enhancement directly improved operational capabilities by allowing frontline personnel to access critical mission data in real-time."

Organizational Effectiveness

- **Border Patrol Agent:** "Identified a recurring bottleneck in the processing of seized vehicles and proposed a revised workflow. Implemented the new standard operating procedure alongside station leadership, which reduced processing time by 30% and freed up agent hours for active patrol duties."
- **Transportation Security Officer (TSO):** "Volunteered to mentor 15 new hires on the updated baggage screening protocols. By creating a standardized quick-reference guide, the onboarding time was reduced by two days per employee, improving team readiness and resource allocation at the checkpoint."
- **IT Specialist:** "Automated the software patch deployment process across the agency's 5,000+ workstations. This initiative eliminated 40 hours of manual labor per month and ensured 99.9% compliance with cybersecurity mandates, greatly improving resource use and network security."

Administration Priorities

- **Border Patrol Agent:** "Supported government-wide fiscal responsibility and efficiency initiatives by cross-training with the logistics team to better maintain patrol vehicles. This proactive preventative maintenance effort reduced vehicle downtime and lowered sector fleet repair costs by 15%."
- **Transportation Security Officer (TSO):** "Advanced customer experience and service delivery mandates by consistently utilizing de-escalation techniques and clear communication during secondary passenger screening. Received five positive customer service commendations from the public this quarter."
- **IT Specialist:** "Led the migration of legacy applications to a modernized infrastructure, directly supporting the Executive Order to modernize government technology and reduce spending. The migration successfully reduced annual server maintenance costs by \$150,000 while improving system reliability."

Helpful Tips and Do's & Don'ts

- Before you begin writing, gather your work products, performance metrics, customer feedback, and any training or awards received during the appraisal period.
- Organize by Critical Elements, this helps your rating official evaluate your performance against established standards.
- Focus on results, not activities: *What was the outcome? Who benefited? What problem was solved? How did my work support organizational goals?*
- Use measurable results and quantify your achievements whenever possible.
- Demonstrate how you achieved results by highlighting the skills and behaviors that contributed to your success, such as collaborating across teams, solving complex problems, mentoring others, or adapting to changing priorities.
- Structure your accomplishments clearly using the STAR framework:
 - Situation:** What was the challenge, requirement, or need?
 - Task:** What were you responsible for?
 - Action:** What specific actions did you take?
 - Result:** What was the outcome or impact?

DOs:

- Be specific and factual
- Use measurable results when possible
- Highlight impact and outcomes

- Proofread before submitting

DON'Ts:

- Simply repeat your position description
- List duties without describing results
- Exaggerate accomplishments
- Use vague statements such as "worked hard" or "did a great job"
- Submit a self-assessment without examples or evidence

Before You Press Submit – Ask Yourself

- Have I addressed each critical element?
- Did I focus on accomplishments rather than activities?
- Did I include measurable results where possible?
- Did I explain the impact of my work on the mission and organizational goals?
- Did I provide specific examples?
- Is my assessment clear, concise, and professional?

Think of your self-assessment as evidence, not advocacy. By documenting your contributions clearly and connecting them to organizational outcomes, you help ensure your performance is fully understood and accurately evaluated.

If you have any questions about the self-assessment process or the required sections, please reach out to your rating official or the Employee Relations Office at cisa.ochco.elr@cisa.dhs.gov. *If your assigned rating official in the system is incorrect, please select "Edit/Change Rating Official" in the system to request an update.*

Thank you for your hard work and dedication this year!

Bob

Robert Dorr
Chief Human Capital Officer
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